

Mary & Joseph / My Beloved

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CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 2 — MARY & JOSEPH / “MY BELOVED”

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 1

Mary and Joseph slowly move toward one another. Joseph still carries the TOOL SATCHEL.

MARY

You're still wearing it.

JOSEPH

Of course I'm still wearing it.

MARY

You haven't even put any tools in it yet.

JOSEPH

I don't want to ruin it.

MARY

Joseph, it's a tool satchel.

JOSEPH

A very nice tool satchel.

MARY

It's supposed to get dirty.

JOSEPH

Eventually.

MARY

You're impossible.

JOSEPH

And yet you made me a satchel.

Mary smiles.

MARY

I'm beginning to reconsider that decision.

JOSEPH

Too late.

He adjusts it proudly.

JOSEPH

It's mine now.

MARY

You seem very pleased with yourself.

JOSEPH

I am.

MARY

Because of the satchel?

JOSEPH

Because you made the satchel.

That lands. Mary tries not to show how much she likes the answer.

MARY

That was almost charming.

JOSEPH

Almost?

MARY

Don't ruin it.

They laugh.

THE FUTURE BECOMES SPECIFIC

Joseph moves to a small, unfinished tabletop/workpiece left from the marketplace and checks it automatically.

MARY

You're working again.

JOSEPH

I'm looking.

MARY

At work.

JOSEPH

That's different.

MARY

Is it?

JOSEPH

Completely.

MARY

What is it?

JOSEPH

It's not finished.

MARY

I gathered that.

JOSEPH

It's for us.

MARY

For us?

JOSEPH

The table.

MARY

The table?

JOSEPH

For the house.

MARY

You already started it?

JOSEPH

Of course I started it.

MARY

We're not married yet.

JOSEPH

That's why I'm starting now.

Mary laughs.

MARY

How big is this table?

JOSEPH

It can hold six.

MARY

Six what?

JOSEPH

People.

MARY

Six?

Joseph studies it.

JOSEPH

Maybe eight.

MARY

Eight?

JOSEPH

Eight gives us room.

MARY

For whom?

JOSEPH

Family. Friends. People passing through. Children.

MARY

Children?

JOSEPH

Eventually.

MARY

How did we go from six chairs to children this quickly?

JOSEPH

I like to plan ahead.

MARY

Clearly.

THE HOUSE THAT DOESN'T EXIST

Joseph begins seeing the home in his imagination. The stage may quietly begin to agree with them through lighting and restrained atmospheric LED content. Do not show a literal house.

JOSEPH

The table goes near the window.

MARY

We have a window?

JOSEPH

We will.

MARY

Good. I wanted one.

JOSEPH

I know.

MARY

How?

JOSEPH

You told me.

MARY

When?

JOSEPH

Twice.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Three times.

MARY

I wanted to make sure you remembered.

JOSEPH

I remember everything you tell me.

MARY

That's a dangerous promise.

JOSEPH

I didn't say I always agree.

Mary laughs.

A warm rectangular suggestion of window light may emerge. LED content, if used, remains abstract: warmth, architectural shadow, faint environmental texture.

MARY

If you're putting the table by the window, I want something growing outside it.

JOSEPH

Something?

MARY

A garden.

JOSEPH

How large?

MARY

Don't plan my garden.

JOSEPH

I'm asking.

MARY

You're measuring it with your eyes.

Joseph realizes she is right and stops.

JOSEPH

Sorry.

MARY

Small.

She considers.

MARY

Maybe not that small.

JOSEPH

Then I'll build a fence.

MARY

For my imaginary garden?

JOSEPH

For the goats that will eat your imaginary garden.

MARY

There are no goats in my imaginary garden.

JOSEPH

That's because I built the fence.

Mary laughs. The imagined home is becoming emotionally tangible without becoming literal.

THE EMOTIONAL SHIFT

The comedy settles. They look at the unfinished table.

MARY

You really see it, don't you?

JOSEPH

What?

MARY

All of it. The house. The table. The garden. Us.

JOSEPH

Don't you?

MARY

I do.

Beat.

MARY

I just... sometimes I wonder if life ever really goes the way people plan it.

JOSEPH

What brought that on?

MARY

Nothing.

A small shrug.

MARY

Look at Nazareth. Everyone thinks they know what comes next. Grow up. Marry. Build a home. Raise a family. Grow old.

JOSEPH

Sounds terrible.

MARY

Joseph.

JOSEPH

I'm listening.

MARY

What if something changes?

JOSEPH

Then something changes.

MARY

That's your answer?

JOSEPH

No.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Then we make another plan.

MARY

And if that one doesn't work?

JOSEPH

Another one.

MARY

Joseph.

JOSEPH

What?

MARY

You really believe there's a plan for everything.

Joseph considers it.

JOSEPH

For everything important.

MARY

That's a lot of confidence.

JOSEPH

I'm building an eight-chair table for a house that doesn't exist yet.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Confidence is required.

Mary smiles, but the question remains.

MARY

What if something happens that you can't plan for?

Joseph looks at her. He does not yet have the mature answer he will earn later.

JOSEPH

Then I'll figure it out.

Mary studies him.

MARY

You make it sound very simple.

JOSEPH

Maybe it is.

MARY

Maybe.

Beat.

MARY

God has always been faithful.

JOSEPH

He has.

MARY

So I suppose whatever comes... We'll find our way through it.

Joseph looks at her. This thought opens the door into the song.

JOSEPH

Whatever comes... I'll walk with you.

MARY

Whatever comes?

JOSEPH

Whatever comes.

"MY BELOVED" BEGINS

Music rises naturally from the silence.

It should feel as though Joseph's promise has created the need to sing.

MUSICAL NUMBER — "MY BELOVED"

DRAMATIC PURPOSE OF THE SONG

The song builds the future they believe they are choosing together.

The lyrics should grow from what the audience has just heard rather than introducing unrelated imagery.

LYRICAL TERRITORY TO DEVELOP

MARY and JOSEPH imagine

the house;

the doorway;

morning light;

the table;

six chairs becoming eight;

friends and family gathered around it;

Mary's garden;

Joseph's work;

ordinary disagreements;

laughter;

children;

knowing where the other person will be at the end of the day;

growing older together;

being chosen by one another.

This is not a song about perfect romance.

It is a song about the beauty of an ordinary shared life.

IMPORTANT SONG MOMENT

At some point near the emotional height of the duet, plant the recurring motif clearly

JOSEPH

Whatever comes, I'll walk with you.

MARY

Whatever comes, I'll walk with you.

MARY & JOSEPH

Whatever comes...

[MUSICAL RESOLUTION / CONTINUATION]

This phrase must be memorable enough that when it returns later, the audience immediately recognizes it.

END OF "MY BELOVED"

The final chord resolves gently. Do not rush into Scene 3. For one moment, there is no crisis, prophecy, gossip or fear. They simply possess the future they believe belongs to them.

JOSEPH

I should go.

MARY

Probably.

He does not move.

MARY

Joseph.

JOSEPH

I'm going.

MARY

You're still here.

JOSEPH

I'm going now.

Mary smiles. Joseph finally starts away, then turns back.

JOSEPH

Tomorrow?

MARY

Tomorrow.

Joseph exits.

TRANSITION INTO SCENE 3 — THE FUTURE DISAPPEARS

Mary remains alone inside the imagined future. Let her be completely happy. She may touch the unfinished table, look toward the imagined window, or simply take in the home they created.

MARY

Eight chairs.

A small laugh.

MARY

Joseph...

Then, on one precise cue, the future disappears. Do NOT crossfade it beautifully.

RUPTURE

LED atmosphere: GONE. Imagined window light: GONE. Garden/environmental texture: GONE. Nazareth ambiance: GONE. "My Beloved" harmonic warmth: GONE.

Silence.

Mary notices. Scene 3 must now introduce a visual and sonic language the production has never used before. Romantic subjective theatricality is over; genuine divine interruption is about to enter.

END SCENE 2.